QP CODE: 24900211

FIRST SEMESTER MGU-UGP (HONOURS) REGULAR EXAMINATION NOVEMBER 2024

First Semester

Discipline Specific Core Course - MGIDSCPJM102 - BASICS OF NEWS REPORTING

(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Answer Scheme

Time: 2 Hours Max. Marks : 70

Part A
Multiple Choice Questions
Answer all questions. each question carries 1 mark

No	Answer
1	c) The potential long-term effects of the story on the audience or society
2	d) One of the reporters who covered the Watergate scandal for The Washington Post
3	d) Right to freedom of speech and expression
4	Wrong options
5	a) News portal
6	b) Expertise and professional background
7	b) Managing the news team and overseeing operations
8	b) Wildlife, conservation, and climate change
9	b) Episodic stories can be watched out of order.
10	c) Objectivity focuses on facts, while subjectivity involves personal opinions and interpretations

Part B
Short Answer Type Questions Answer any ten questions. each question carries 3 marks

No	Answer
11	Stories that fall in the hard news category report specific, tangible events such as fire, accident and death of a prominent person. Hard news consists of basic facts. It is news of important public events, international happenings, social conditions, economy, crime, etc. thus, most of the material found in daily papers, especially from page items or news casts, deal in the hard news category. The main aim of the hard news is to inform. News stories that provide explanations, analyses and interpretations are known as soft news. This is a term for all the news that isn't time-sensitive. Soft news includes profiles of people, programs or organizations.
12	News stories and feature stories are two distinct forms of journalism. News stories prioritize timeliness, accuracy, and objectivity, focusing on delivering factual information about breaking news events or current issues. They are structured in an inverted pyramid style, with the most important information presented first. Feature stories, on the other hand, delve deeper into a topic, often exploring human interest angles, historical context, or future implications. They prioritize storytelling, analysis, and engagement, employing a more flexible structure and creative language. While news stories inform, feature stories aim to inform, entertain, or persuade.
13	Hyperlocal news focuses on reporting news and events within a very specific geographic area, such as a neighborhood, town, or small city. It covers topics that are relevant to the local community, like community events, local businesses, school news, crime reports, and local government issues. Hyperlocal news often relies on citizen journalism and community engagement to gather information and share stories. It aims to provide a platform for local voices and bridge the gap between the community and larger news organizations.
14	Source cultivation is a crucial aspect of news gathering that involves building and maintaining relationships with reliable sources. It entails identifying potential sources, understanding their expertise and credibility, and establishing trust through consistent communication and ethical

	reporting. By cultivating sources, journalists can gain exclusive access to information, insights, and perspectives that enhance the quality and depth of their reporting. This practice is particularly important in investigative journalism, where trust and confidentiality are essential for uncovering hidden truths and holding the powerful accountable.
15	A press release is a formal written statement issued by an organization to provide information to the media and the public. Its primary purpose is to disseminate news or announcements in a timely and controlled manner. By crafting a compelling press release, organizations can attract media attention, generate publicity, and shape public perception. They are commonly used to announce product launches, company milestones, mergers and acquisitions, crisis communications, or any other newsworthy event.
16	Exit polls play a crucial role in election reporting by providing immediate insights into voter behavior and preferences, even before official results are announced. They help identify trends such as which demographics supported specific candidates, key issues influencing voter decisions, and shifts in voting patterns compared to previous elections. For media outlets, exit polls serve as a tool to frame early narratives and analyze the electoral landscape while engaging audiences with data-driven commentary. However, while they can indicate probable outcomes, their accuracy is subject to sampling methods and cannot replace official vote counts.
17	Embedded journalism refers to the practice of journalists being attached to military units or other organizations during conflicts or significant operations, providing firsthand, real-time coverage. This approach allows reporters to access restricted areas, witness events directly, and offer in-depth stories from the frontlines. It aims to enhance transparency and provide audiences with a closer understanding of complex situations. However, embedded journalism can raise ethical concerns, such as potential bias due to close proximity to the military or limitations on reporting imposed by host organizations, which might affect the objectivity and independence of the coverage.
18	The Chief Reporter plays a pivotal role in ensuring timely and accurate reporting by coordinating the newsroom's activities and overseeing the team of journalists. They assign stories, set deadlines, and provide guidance to reporters, ensuring that coverage aligns with editorial standards and organizational goals. By verifying sources, fact-checking content, and maintaining communication with field reporters, the Chief Reporter upholds the credibility of the news. Additionally, they manage breaking news situations, prioritize stories, and ensure seamless collaboration between reporters, editors, and other departments, thereby maintaining the efficiency and reliability of news dissemination.
19	Audience feedback is vital in shaping the direction of a TV series as it provides creators with valuable insights into viewers' preferences, expectations, and emotional engagement with the show. Feedback, gathered through ratings, social media interactions, focus groups, or online reviews, helps producers understand which characters, storylines, or themes resonate most with the audience. This input can guide decisions on plot developments, pacing, or even the inclusion or exclusion of characters to enhance viewer satisfaction and loyalty. By responding to audience reactions, creators can ensure the series remains relevant, increases its appeal, and sustains its popularity over time.
20	● General answer
21	Blogging differs from traditional journalism in content creation through its approach, tone, and purpose. Bloggers often have the freedom to express personal opinions, share experiences, or explore niche topics without adhering to the strict editorial guidelines typical in traditional journalism. Unlike journalism, which prioritizes objective reporting and factual accuracy, blogging is often more informal and subjective, allowing for creative storytelling and a conversational style. Bloggers typically engage directly with their audience, focusing on building a personal brand or community, while journalists work within structured media organizations to provide news that adheres to established ethical standards and public interest mandates.
22	Short, simple sentences in radio scripts are highly effective because they enhance clarity and ensure the message is easily understood by listeners who cannot re-read or pause the content. This style suits the conversational tone of radio, maintaining the audience's attention while accommodating the medium's fast-paced nature. Concise sentences minimize confusion, reduce the chance of misinterpretation, and allow the presenter to maintain a natural and engaging delivery. Additionally, they are especially important when conveying critical information or breaking news, where brevity and precision are essential for impact and comprehension.

Part C
Essay Type Questions Answer any two questions. each question carries 15 marks

No	Answer
23	Balance in news reporting is essential to ensure fairness, accuracy, and credibility, allowing audiences to form informed opinions. A balanced report presents all relevant perspectives on an issue, avoiding favoritism or bias toward any party or viewpoint. This approach fosters trust between the media and the public while upholding journalistic ethics. By giving equal weight to conflicting arguments and providing context, balanced reporting helps prevent misinformation and reduces polarization. It also ensures that minority voices are heard, contributing to a more comprehensive understanding of complex issues.
24	● Informational Interview: Focuses on gathering facts and insights from experts or individuals knowledgeable about a specific topic. ● Investigative Interview: Aimed at uncovering hidden or controversial information, often involving probing questions. ● Personality Profile Interview: Highlights the personal stories, experiences, and achievements of a public figure or individual of interest. ● Opinion-Based Interview: Centers on the interviewee's opinions or viewpoints on current events or societal issues. ● Live Interview: Conducted in real-time, often during a broadcast, requiring spontaneous and dynamic responses. ● Pre-recorded Interview: Recorded in advance and edited for clarity or time constraints before airing. ● Hard News Interview: Focuses on pressing and significant issues, often requiring direct and tough questioning. ● Soft News Interview: Covers lighter, human-interest stories with a conversational and relaxed tone. ● On-the-Street Interview (Vox Pop): Collects public opinion by interviewing random people in public spaces. ● Press Conference Interview: Involves multiple journalists asking questions during a formal event organized by a newsmaker or organization. ● Crisis or Emergency Interview: Conducted during a crisis to provide updates or clarify urgent issues. ● Follow-Up Interview: Revisits a previous story or topic to provide updates or new perspectives.
25	Journalists face significant challenges in investigative reporting when working with anonymous sources, as the credibility and reliability of such information can be difficult to verify. Protecting the source's identity while ensuring the accuracy of their claims requires meticulous fact-checking and corroboration from additional evidence or witnesses. Legal risks also arise, as journalists may face subpoenas or lawsuits demanding source disclosure, putting both their integrity and the source's safety at stake. Furthermore, anonymous sources can sometimes have hidden agendas, making it essential for reporters to assess their motives critically. Balancing these complexities while maintaining journalistic ethics and producing a compelling, truthful story is a demanding task.
26	General answer